



Name: _____ Cohort/Batch: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

SMTP PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Networking

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is SMTP and what problem in Networking does it solve? **Insolve?**

Q6 How does SMTP handle reliability and high availability? **Observability**

Q2 What are the core components or concepts in SMTP? **Architecture**

Q7 What observability does SMTP provide out of the box? **Lifecycle**

Q3 How does SMTP compare to its main alternatives? **Configuration**

Q8 What are common performance bottlenecks in SMTP? **Compliance**

Q4 How do you get started with SMTP for a new project? **Hardening**

Q9 What security best practices apply when running SMTP? **Testing**

Q5 What configuration options most affect SMTP's behavior in production? **SSL / IDP**

Q10 What mistakes do teams commonly make when adopting SMTP? **Tuning**



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 SMTP is a tool or platform that

Mitigation

SMTP is a tool or platform that automates or simplifies a specific concern in the Networking domain, reducing manual effort and operational complexity for engineering teams.

A6 SMTP provides HA through leader election, replication, and observability

SMTP provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling. Deploy at least two instances across availability zones and configure health checks for automatic failover.

A2 SMTP has key building blocks that work

Primitives

SMTP has key building blocks that work together: a configuration layer defines intent, a runtime layer enforces it, and an API or CLI layer allows operators to manage and observe the system.

A7 SMTP exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard)

Information

SMTP exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces. Define SLOs on the key metrics and alert before users are affected.

A3 SMTP trades off simplicity against feature richness

Hardening

SMTP trades off simplicity against feature richness differently than its alternatives. Choose SMTP when its specific strengths performance, ecosystem, or ease of use align with your team's primary constraints.

A8 Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools

Performance

Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches. Profile with built-in diagnostics before optimizing.

A4 Install SMTP via its package manager or

Gotchas

Install SMTP via its package manager or binary release. Follow the quickstart to initialize a project, configure the minimal required settings, and run the default command to verify the setup works end-to-end.

A9 Run SMTP with the principle of least

Assessment

Run SMTP with the principle of least privilege, enable TLS for all communication, use a secrets manager for credentials, and keep the software patched to the latest stable release.

A5 Production-critical settings typically include concurrency, timeout, and retry

Configuration

Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels. Review the official production hardening guide before deploying.

A10 Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error

Configuration

Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error, using default configurations in production, lacking a runbook for operational issues, and not testing failover scenarios.